FREE CHECKLIST · VA AT AI EP 5

AI and Client Data: Privacy Checklist

The client's data is not yours. Use AI in a way that keeps their trust.

Never paste into AI	Usually fine in an approved tool
Passwords, OTPs and logins	Email drafts with no personal details
Card, bank and ID numbers	Captions, outlines and blog ideas
Full customer lists with emails and phones	Grammar and tone fixes
Medical, legal or HR details	Formulas, templates and SOPs
Contracts and private business plans	Dummy or sample data for testing

Anonymise before you paste

☐ Remove names, emails, phone numbers and addresses
☐ Remove invoice, order, card and account numbers
☐ Replace them with placeholders like [CUSTOMER] or [ORDER]
☐ After the AI draft, put the real details back inside the client's own system

If you use ChatGPT

☐ Settings, Data controls: turn off "Improve the model for everyone"
☐ Use Temporary Chat for one-off tasks (not used for training, deleted within 30 days)
☐ Even with training off, never paste sensitive data

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AI policy questions and habits

Ask once, agree in writing, then work with confidence.

MESSAGE TO YOUR CLIENT

Hi [Name], quick question before I start. I sometimes use AI to draft and organise work faster, and I always check the output myself. Is that OK for this task? If yes, which AI tools are approved, and is there any data I should never put into AI?

4 habits of a safe VA

☐ Least data: use only what the task needs
☐ Approved tools only, through the client's account when possible
☐ No copied passwords: use the client's password manager
☐ Clean up: delete downloaded files when the task is done

If something goes wrong

☐ Stop and do not paste anything else
☐ Tell the client right away, with what was shared and where
☐ Delete the chat or file if the tool allows it
☐ Agree on what to do differently next time

Philippines: Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173). The National Privacy Commission issued guidelines in December 2024 confirming the law applies to AI systems that process personal data. Clients abroad may also follow their own laws, such as GDPR. This is general guidance, not legal advice.